

What to buy: 3-D GAMING CONSOLE OR LAPTOP?

The choice depends on what kind of gamer you are. For regular gamers, a high-end graphics-enabled PC will give the flexibility of gaming and computing in a single machine. Those looking at high-end gaming applications are advised to go for a dedicated gaming console

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The runaway success of movies like *Avatar* has quickly brought the 3-D technology into the mainstream. It has not only generated interest in the technology but also urged companies to launch 3-D-enabled computers, TV sets, etc. Just as it is revolutionising the movie industry, 3-D technology shall revolutionise the gaming industry as well.

Devices capable of 3-D gaming have already started appearing in the market. Basically, to enjoy 3-D gaming, you have three options: PCs (desktops and laptops), projectors and gaming consoles. With a laptop or desktop, you require a 3-D-enabled monitor and 3-D glasses. With a 3-D projector too, you would require 3-D glasses as the image is still 2-D (having length and breadth). Glasses create the impression of depth.

The choice between a dedicated 3-D gaming console and a 3-D-capable com-

puter depends on what kind of gamer you are. For regular gamers, a high-end graphics-enabled PC is recommended from everyday usage perspective. It will give you the flexibility of gaming and computing in a single machine.

"Personally speaking, I would any day go for a gaming PC, as most of the games provide a PC version. Also, a gaming PC can substitute a desktop PC and be used for work and entertainment or even more functions. A gaming console doesn't offer all these features and,

looking at the present scenario, consumers are always looking out for gadgets that can multi-task and don't mind investing in such high-end products," says Alex Huang, general manager-system business group, ASUS (India).

On the other hand, those looking at high-end gaming applications are advised to go for a dedicated gaming console.

3-D gaming console

There are three big names in gaming consoles: Sony, Microsoft and Nintendo. Sony offers the PlayStation (PS3) range, Microsoft Xbox and Nintendo Wii. There is considerable action happening around 3-D, with Nintendo unveiling the first portable gaming console. You won't need special glasses to play games in 3-D on Nintendo's newest handheld



Sony PlayStation 3